

7.1 Introduction

The concept of "Favorites" has evolved from a time where all links were just bookmarked in your browser. Now, bookmarking sites offer services that let you register, store your bookmarks, organise them and categorise them in the way you want by adding tags. Most importantly, these sites give you an option of keeping those bookmarks private or accessible by the public.

Bookmarking services usually show the bookmark creator's name and link to his/her bookmark compilation. This makes it easy for visitors to connect with other individuals by accessing and sharing bookmarks of similar interests. Most of these sites have user-contributed content - visitors can only view the bookmarks and comments, while only registered members can vote, rate and comment on a particular post.

Thus, like-minded individuals can unite, create communities based on their common interests and discover new Web sites through mutual exchange of bookmarks. Thus this activity has been called 'Social Bookmarking'. Today, social bookmarking is spreading like wildfire. People check their feeds and bookmarking accounts simultaneously for the latest news of interest.

For all such sites, registration is essential to avail of features like rating, voting or commenting. However, some sites offer lot of features even without registration. We have some jargon that needs to be explained first.

Tags

Tags are single word labels that are assigned to bookmarks in order to organise and remember them. For instance, all links of news stories or articles related to iPod, iPhone, Final Cut Pro, Mac OS X or Safari can be given a common tag - Apple.

Tag Clouds

A tag cloud is the visual description and random placement of